HA-JOON CHUNG

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Research Interests

Education, Labor Market Stratification, Family Sociology, Causal Mediation Analysis

Academic Employment

2026-present Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Sociology
Princeton University

2019-present Research Assistant, Committee on Quantitative Research Methods
University of Chicago

Education

2026 Princeton University – Princeton, NJ
Ph.D., Sociology and Social Policy
Committee: James M. Raymo (chair), Guanglei Hong, Brandon Stewart, Florencia Torche, Yu Xie

2019 University of Chicago – Chicago, IL
M.A., Social Sciences (Concentration: Quantitative Methods & Social Analysis)
Advisor: Stephen W. Raudenbush

2018 Yonsei University – Seoul, South Korea
B.A., Sociology

Additional Training

2026 Certificate in Demography, Office of Population Research, Princeton University

2026 Certificate in Statistics and Machine Learning, Center for Statistics and Machine Learning, Princeton University

2024 10th Annual Berkeley Workshop on Formal Demography, University of California, Berkeley

2018 Korean National Teacher's License (Secondary, Social Studies), Yonsei University

Publications

Chung, H-J., & Raymo, J. 2026. "Concerted Cultivation and Children's Academic Performance: The Role of School Belongingness." *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*

Chung, H-J., & Hong, G. 2025. "Real-World Implications of a Methodological Dilemma: Endogenous Confounding in Causal Decomposition Analysis."
In *Causal Inference*, edited by Xiao-Hua Zhou and Jinzhu Jia, 49–64. Singapore: Springer Nature.

Hong, G., & **Chung, H.-J.** 2024. "Assessing the Impact of the Great Recession on the Transition to Adulthood." *Sociological Methods & Research* 53 (3): 1453–90.

Selected Work in Progress

Chung, H-J., & Jang, M. "The Skill Profile of College Majors: A Multidimensional Approach to Occupational Mismatch and Wages." *American Journal of Sociology* (Revised & Resubmitted)

Chung, H-J., & Hong, G. "Scope and Scale of Educational Interventions: Sociological Implications of Causal Decomposition Analysis."

Chung, H-J. "Educational Gradient at the Top: Variations in Fertility Timing of Young Adults by College Prestige." (Dissertation Chapter)

Chung, H-J. "Changing Value of Educational Credential in the Marriage Market." (Dissertation

Chapter)

Chung, H-J. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty in Major-Occupation Mismatch."

Chung, H-J. "Vulnerable Majors, Resilient Majors: Higher Education in the Era of Generative AI"

Raymo, J., Park, H., & **Chung, H-J.** "Children's Educational Attainment as a Component of Family Success: Vignette Experiments in 8 Countries."

Grants and Research Funding

2023-2025 Graduate Funding for Research, Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies (PIIRS)
Independently designed and carried out an international research project on class and childrearing in South Korea; managed the project budget and secured IRB approval for data collection.

2023 William T. Grant Foundation, Research Grant Application
"Would Reducing Inequality in STEM Learning Mitigate the Differential Impacts of a Global Crisis?" Co-developed with Guanglei Hong (PI). Letter of Inquiry selected to advance to the full-proposal stage; Not funded.

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

2024-25 Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University
A competitive, interdisciplinary fellowship for policy-relevant social science.

2019 Princeton Fellowship in the Humanities and Social Sciences, Princeton University

Teaching

Fall 2026 Assistant Instructor: **Applied Social Statistics (Graduate-level)**
Instructor: Brandon M. Stewart, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

Fall 2022, Fall 2021 Assistant Instructor: **Statistical Methods in Sociology**
Instructor: Tod G. Hamilton, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

Spring 2023 Assistant Instructor: **Sociological Theory**
Instructor: John N. Robinson III, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

Spring 2022 Assistant Instructor: **Machine Learning with Social Data: Opportunities and Challenges**
Instructor: Brandon M. Stewart, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

K-12 Teaching (South Korea)

2018 Student Teacher, Shin-il Middle School, Seoul (Subject: Social Studies)

2012, 2015-16 Volunteer Teacher, after-school programs at Hwagea Elementary and Shin-il/Banghak Middle Schools, Seoul

Professional Presentations

American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting
2025 — Presenter. "Occupational Potential of College Majors: Measurement and Application"
"Household Pets in Lowest-low Fertility Contexts: The Case of South Korea and Japan"
2024 — Roundtable. "School-to-Work Transition: The Story of Path Dependency and Agency."
2023 — Roundtable. "A New Solution to Endogenous Confounding in Racial Disparity Decomposition."
2022 — Roundtable. "Revisiting Cultural Capital in the School Context."

Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting
2026 — Presenter. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty and Major-Occupation Mismatch"
Poster. "Race-Blind or Race-Conscious: Substantive Implications of a Methodological Dilemma"
2025 — Poster. "Education Gradient at the Top: 4-Year College Prestige and Fertility Behavior."

2024 — Presenter. "Investment in Children and Children's Educational Attainment as Components of Family Success: Vignette Experiments in 8 Countries"

Poster. "Mismatch at the Bottom: Education-Income Exchange in Marriages."

2023 — Poster. "The Heterogeneous Great Recession Effect on Child Development."

2022 — Presenter. "Parenting in a 'Class-Homogenized Cultivation' Society: Class and Childrearing in South Korea."

Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Annual Conference

2026 — Presenter. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty and Major-Occupation Mismatch"

2025 (Milan) — Presenter. "School Adjustment as the Mechanism of Classed Parenting Effect on Achievement: The Case of South Korea."

2024 — Presenter. "Reducing the Racial Gap in the Horizontally Stratified Colleges: Implications for Single Pregnancy During Emerging Adulthood."

Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE) Summer Conference

2024 — Presenter. "An Equity-Oriented Approach to Causal Decomposition Analysis."

Research on East Asian Demography and Inequality (READI) Summer Conference

2023 — Presenter. "What They Want, What They Do: Classed Parenting in a 'Universal Concerted Cultivation' Society."

International Conference on Sociology of Korea (I-CSK), Univ. of Pennsylvania

2024 — Presenter. "Is It All Puppies and Rainbows?: Household Pets in the Lowest-Low Fertility Context."

People & Organization Conference, The Wharton School, Univ. of Pennsylvania

2025 — Presenter. "Skill-expectation and Achievement: Revisting the College Major-Occupation Mismatch"

Community Organization and Other Services

2024-present Co-organizer, Research on East Asian Demography and Inequality (READI) Early Career Workshop
Organize a monthly research workshop for graduate students and early-career scholars studying East Asia; organize a professionalization event at the PAA annual meeting

2023-2024 Representative, Graduate Student Action Committee, Office of Population Research, Princeton University
Organized professionalization sessions, student research and writing workshops, and departmental social events

2022-2023 Co-organizer, Family Demography Working Group, Princeton University
Co-organized workshops with James Raymo and Alicia Adserà; facilitated student presentations of works-in-progress

2022-2026 Residential Graduate Student, Yeh College, Princeton University
Advise 30–40 first-year undergraduates annually on coursework and university life; support graduating seniors with thesis writing; organize social and professionalization events

Programming, Software, and Language Skills

Programming languages: R, Stata, Python (natural language processing)

Languages: Korean (native), Japanese (intermediate)